Séquence 1

Stardom: privilege or pain?

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"One thing about being successful is that I stopped being afraid of dying. Once you're a star you're dead already. You're embalmed."

Dustin Hoffman

UNHCR goodwill ambassador Angelina Jolie.
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Objectifs de la séquence

Dans cette séquence, vous allez apprendre à exprimer et à justifier votre réaction par rapport à un incident ou événement concernant une star.

Pour cela, des activités vous seront proposées à partir de documents variés liés aux activités et aux opinions de personnalités célèbres du monde anglophone, pour vous informer et développer vos compétences en lecture, en audition et en expression orale et écrite.

1. Get ready

Vous allez vous familiariser avec le lexique associé au monde des célébrités et réfléchir à ce que signifie être célèbre.

2. Learning to read press articles about famous people

Vous étudierez un extrait de presse dans lequel on parle d'une célébrité. Cela vous familiarisera avec le style et la structure d'un tel article.

3. Understanding people expressing and justifying their opinion

Vous développerez votre capacité à repérer les idées essentielles d'une argumentation à l'oral en travaillant sur les unités de sens et les mots accentués. Vous identifierez les éléments qui relèvent de la subjectivité de l'énonciateur et les expressions d'opinion, avant de vous en servir pour exprimer votre propre avis.

4. Developing your ideas on fame and your reading skills

Vous vous entraînerez à effectuer des repérages de base pour identifier les idées principales d'un document écrit, avant de revoir les expressions de cause et de conséquence.

5. Making logical connections and drawing up a synthesis

Vous allez apprendre à analyser les différents documents qui constituent un dossier afin d'identifier les divergences et les convergences afin d'en tirer une synthèse. Nous vous guiderons dans la planification d'une présentation orale de vos idées sur le sujet. Vous aurez l'occasion d'analyser les éléments linguistiques les plus utiles pour argumenter.

6. On the way to autonomy

Il s'agit d'un dernier entraînement avant l'évaluation de cette séquence. L'activité proposée est semblable à celle réalisée dans la phase précédente, mais cette fois-ci, nous retirons les béquilles, et vous devez travailler seul avant de confronter votre prestation avec la réponse modèle. La phase correction vous permettra de remédier à d'éventuelles lacunes.

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1 Get ready: getting to know the world of fame

Activity 1

❶ Do the following quiz to find out what fame (or celebrity) means for you at this moment in time.

	Yes	No	It depends
1. To be famous, you must be photogenic.			
2. Famous people are invariably extroverts.			
3. Celebrities enjoy being in the public eye.			
4. Stars like other people trying to be as good as them.			
5. A star always takes care of his/her appearance.			
6. At the end of the day, it's the public who decide who is to become famous.			
7. People who are elected to occupy a function are invariably well known.			
8. As far as finance goes for stars, the sky's the limit!			
9. Celebrity goes to people's heads and makes them egocentric.			
10. Stars sometimes deliberately create scandal so as to be in the news.			
11. Famous people take advantage of their celebrity to try to defend important causes.			
12. Celebrities become so dependent on their entourage they forget how to solve problems for themselves.			

❷ Now do this quiz to find out if you have what it takes to be famous.

a. Your friends describe you as,

- ☐ just about right.
- ☐ quiet and undemonstrative.
- ☐ always in the limelight*.

* Voir l'encadré "Vocabulary notes" pages suivantes.

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b. If you were invited to appear on MTV,

- ☐ it would be a nightmare. You enjoy your privacy* too much.
- ☐ you'd accept immediately – you've always known you'd be on prime time* in the not too distant future.
- ☐ you'd be flattered for a minute, then become rational and decline as it's not your world.

c. If you have to rush out somewhere, even if it's to the corner shop to buy a Coke,

- ☐ you check how you look in the mirror.
- ☐ you put on your dark glasses so that no one recognises you.
- ☐ you go as you are, without bothering to look in the mirror.

d. On your holiday photos,

- ☐ you always look your best*.
- ☐ your eyes are closed in most of the pictures.
- ☐ you were always taking the pictures.

e. You bump into your favourite star at your holiday destination,

- ☐ You admire him/her from a distance, happy that you have a story to tell your mates.
- ☐ You snap as many photos as you can with your cell phone so as to be able to copy their look.
- ☐ You draw attention to yourself (singing/breakdancing/talking in a loud voice) in the hope of impressing them with your tremendous talent.

f. At school, or with an association,

- ☐ you have already played the leading role* in a play*.
- ☐ you have already declined a supporting role*, as you refuse to accept a secondary role.
- ☐ you have already played a minor role.
- ☐ you have never been invited (or wanted) to participate in a play.

g. At school, or with an association,

- ☐ you have already been elected to an important position (class representative/association secretary/president etc.).
- ☐ you have already stood for election for an important position.
- ☐ you have never wanted to be elected.

h. Once you have achieved stardom*, you will spend your money on,

- ☐ material things (cars, homes, bling).
- ☐ savings.
- ☐ drugs/alcohol.
- ☐ political campaigns.
- ☐ charitable causes.

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Vocabulary notes

To be in the limelight: to be the focus of attention.

To enjoy privacy: to appreciate one's private life.

To be on prime time: to be on (TV) when there is the highest number of viewers.

To look your best: to take special care with your appearance.

The leading role: the most important role (in a movie or the theatre).

A play: literary work intended to be performed in the theatre.

A supporting role: a secondary role.

Stardom: star status; the state of being a star.

To whine: to complain in an irritating manner (high-pitched cry).

i. As a star, you will invariably have to apologise about,

- ☐ racist remarks.
- ☐ drug/alcohol abuse.
- ☐ fighting/act of violence.
- ☐ nothing. You never do anything that bad.

j. You expect to become,

- ☐ an accomplished actor.
- ☐ a rock star.
- ☐ a politician on the world forum.
- ☐ a winner of the Nobel Prize (Peace/Literature/Science...).
- ☐ a reality show winner.
- ☐ a DJ.
- ☐ a TV presenter.
- ☐ President of the most important company in the world.

k. When something irritates you,

- ☐ you cry.
- ☐ you write a song about your feelings.
- ☐ you take political action to try to change things.
- ☐ you whine* and complain loudly.
- ☐ you sit quietly.
- ☐ you beat up paparazzi.

l. If your computer breaks down,

- ☐ you call someone else to fix it.
- ☐ you buy a new one.
- ☐ you try to fix it.
- ☐ you keep staring at it.
- ☐ you hit it with a hammer.

3 Draw your own conclusions. Are you celebrity material? Do you have the profile of a star? Do you have what it takes to be famous? Complete the appropriate sentence giving at least three reasons.

☐ I have what it takes to be a celebrity because...

☐ I don't have what it takes to be a celebrity because...

Now check your answers to the quiz to obtain an accurate analysis of your profile!

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Comment enrichir son lexique

Quand on travaille seul à distance comme vous, il est indispensable de se donner les moyens de tirer le maximum de profit de toutes les activités. À l'école, votre professeur d'anglais vous proposerait des contrôles de lexique réguliers pour vous obliger à apprendre. Ici, vous êtes votre propre chef. Vous faites l'effort, vous serez récompensé par la rapidité de vos progrès. Vous ne le faites pas, votre niveau d'anglais va stagner, voire se fossiliser…

Voici les étapes principales qui vous permettront de progresser au niveau du lexique.

1. Apprentissage de nouveaux mots

a. Vous avez besoin de noter le nouveau lexique (l'endroit – répertoire/cahier/feuille volante/post-it, c'est votre choix). Ce qui compte, ce sont les différents éléments que vous associez à ce mot :

- sa signification (en français, ou encore mieux un synonyme en anglais);
- sa prononciation (du moins, en quoi ce mot se prononce différemment du français : les sons voyelles particuliers, la syllabe accentuée) [Vous n'êtes pas obligé de connaître la phonétique par cœur, mais vous allez vite vous rendre compte qu'il s'agit d'un outil bien utile pour annoter la prononciation de la partie problématique d'un mot. Inutile de vous entraîner à transcrire des mots entiers en phonétique, ce qui importe c'est que vous sachiez lire les sons qui diffèrent du français.];
- l'utilisation du mot dans la phrase : Quel connecteur faut-il utiliser si connecteur il y a? Y a-t-il une construction particulière à utiliser?

b. Il faut mémoriser ce mot en choisissant le moyen qui vous convient. Pour certains, il suffit d'apprendre les éléments mis en avant ci-dessus. Pour d'autres, il est plus facile d'apprendre le mot dans une phrase – celle du texte dans lequel vous l'avez trouvé, celle que vous avez construite vous-même, celle d'une chanson qui vous trotte dans la tête. Encore une fois, vous avez toute latitude, mais cet effort de mémorisation est indispensable.

2. Mobilisation/acquisition d'un champ lexical

En général, que ce soit en cours ou dans la vie de tous les jours, derrière chaque mot, il y a tout un champ lexical qui se dessine. Bien souvent, la plupart des mots d'un champ lexical vous sont déjà connus. Mais attention! Il y a une différence entre reconnaître du lexique dans un document et pouvoir récupérer ce mot dans sa mémoire pour s'en servir soi-même. Autrement dit, si vous ne faites pas d'effort pour transformer le vocabulaire de reconnaissance en vocabulaire actif, vous n'allez pas pouvoir vous en servir pour vous exprimer. Que faut-il faire?

a. S'amuser à faire des classements par synonymie (les mots qui ont le même sens) ou par antonymie (les mots qui ont un sens contraire) pour un champ lexical donné.

b. Créer un système de classement qui vous permet de rassembler le maximum de mots pour un champ lexical donné (organigramme/tableau à multiples entrées/marguerite etc.)

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3. Fixation du lexique

Si vous omettez cette phase, votre apprentissage ne sera pas réussi. Il faut absolument passer par une phase de production pour fixer le lexique que vous avez cherché à classer et à mémoriser.

a. Réalisez concrètement et pas simplement par la pensée toutes les activités que l'on vous propose. Le fait de dire ou d'écrire des phrases avec le nouveau lexique renforce la fixation.

b. Amusez-vous à construire vos propres énoncés qui ont une signification toute particulière pour vous. Vous les retiendrez plus facilement et donc le lexique sera bien mémorisé.

c. Chaque fois que l'occasion se présente (dans les séquences ultérieures/dans l'usage que vous faites de l'anglais à titre privé), efforcez-vous de réactiver ce lexique, ce champ lexical.

Activity 2

Now put our recommendations into practice and do the following exercises to facilitate your memorisation of the vocabulary in Activity 1.

1 Complete the table with the appropriate synonyms from the box below and indicate if each word is preceded by "a"(*article indéfini*) or Ø (*article zéro*).

Read the Grammar Tip below first if you are unsure about when to use the articles.

celebrity star stardom

	..... fame	
	..... famous person	

Grammar tip

On utilise l'article indéfini pour marquer un nom dénombrable singulier non spécifié : *Un homme → A man*

Lorsque le nom dénombrable est au pluriel et non spécifié (= en général), on utilise l'ensemble vide : *Les hommes → Ø Men*

Lorsque cet élément est spécifié (on l'identifie clairement), il faut utiliser l'article défini : *L'homme à la porte → The man at the door*

Les hommes à la porte → The men at the door

S'il s'agit d'un nom indénombrable non spécifié, c'est l'article zéro qui convient : *Le courage est une valeur rare → Ø Courage often lacks*

Si cet élément est spécifié, c'est l'article défini qui s'impose : *Le courage de l'homme à la porte me surprit → The courage of the man at the door surprised me.*

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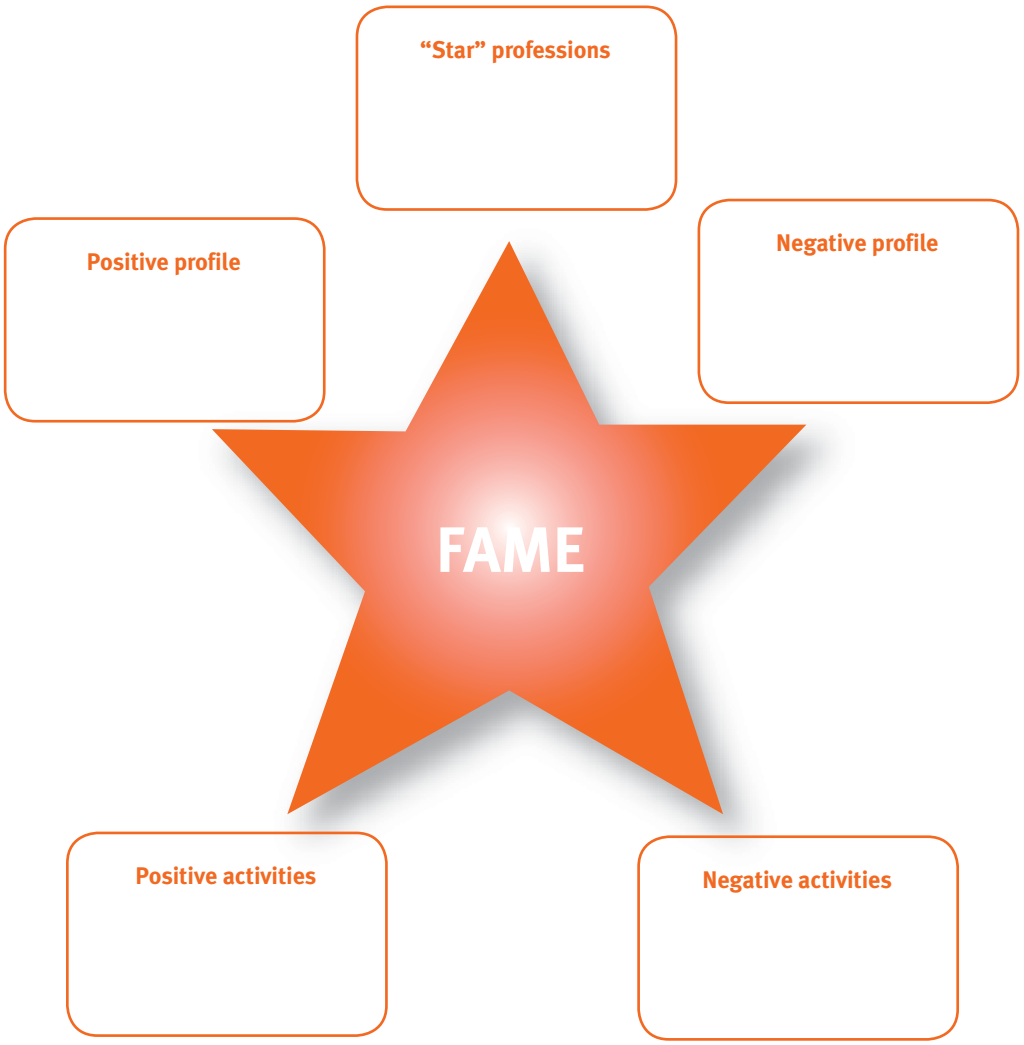
2 Find synonyms for the following expressions in the activities above.

to become famous: .....

to be in the public eye: .....

3 Use the vocabulary from Activity 1 to create a spidergram about FAME.



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Activity 3

1 Choose two famous people: your idol (the one you admire the most) and your pet hate (the one you appreciate the least). Write their names at the top of the table below and check off their qualities. (Yes/No/DK* = Don't Know)

	YOUR IDOL			YOUR PET HATE		
	Yes	No	DK*	Yes	No	DK*
Tends to find fault with others						
Is helpful and unselfish with others						
Can be cold and aloof						
Is considerate and kind to almost everyone						
Is sometimes rude (impolite) to others						
Likes to cooperate with others						
Can be somewhat careless						
Tends to be lazy						
Does things efficiently						
Is easily distracted						
Is talkative						
Is reserved						
Is full of energy						
Has an assertive personality						
Is sometimes shy, inhibited						
Is outgoing, sociable						
Is depressed, blue						
Is relaxed, handles stress well						
Can be tense						
Is original, comes up with new ideas						
Is curious about many different things						
Has an active imagination						
Is inventive						
Values artistic, aesthetic experiences						
Likes to reflect, play with ideas						
Has few (not many) artistic interests						
Is sophisticated in art, music, or literature						

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2 You are going to write a paragraph to explain why you like your idol so much and why you dislike the other celebrity, using the vocabulary in the document to help you.

First of all, study this model answer:

The two celebrities that stand out the most in my mind are Madonna and Barack Obama. The American President is someone I admire immensely: ***in spite of*** *his immense power, he remains humble and true to his origins. He gives the impression that he really wants to help the citizens of the world live in peace, and is willing to cooperate with all the other great leaders to attain this objective. He has an assertive personality,* ***and yet*** *at the same time he is a ready listener. He has shown that he can handle stress well and that he is curious about everything possible.* ***On the other hand****, Madonna is someone that I appreciate far less than I used to. She is selfish and has no scruples about criticising people in public.* ***Although*** *she too has an assertive personality, she is cold and aloof. On an artistic level, it's true that she demonstrates a lot of originality, but* ***unlike*** *Obama, she never takes other people's feelings into consideration and is often deliberately provocative. I get the impression she actually enjoys negative publicity!*

a. How many propositions (Subject + Verb + Complement) do most sentences contain?

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3

The propositions are connected by simple link words (connectors) like "and"or more sophisticated ones.

b. Match the link words (in bold print in the text) with the appropriate synonym and the translation in French. (Draw an arrow → to do this):

In spite of	Contrary to	*À la difference de*
And yet	Despite	*Bien que*
On the other hand	Even if	*Malgré*
Although	However	*Par contre*
Unlike	In contrast	*Pourtant*

c. Quels mots de liaison, dans la liste ci-dessus, sont suivis d'un complément (un nom simple) et ceux suivis d'une proposition complète?

Mot de liaison + complément	Mot de liaison + proposition complète (sujet + verbe + complément)

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d. Underline the expressions in the text which express the writer's opinion.

Check your answers.

❸ Now, write your own paragraph about your two celebrities – your idol and your pet hate.

Apprendre à s'auto-évaluer

Plus vous avez un regard critique par rapport à votre travail, plus vous allez progresser. Soyez exigeant avec vous-même. En classe de Première, vous êtes censé tous avoir une bonne maîtrise de l'anglais du point de vue lexical et grammatical. (Si ce n'est pas le cas, il vous faut travailler ces domaines en priorité). Ce qui fait la différence, et ce qui vous fera gagner des points précieux au baccalauréat, ce sera le fait d'avoir développé un certain style qui passe par la complexification et l'enrichissement de l'expression.

On va vous guider pour cette première auto-évaluation de la production écrite :

	oui	non
1. Avez-vous respecté la conjugaison à la troisième personne?		
2. Faites-vous bien la distinction entre les substantifs et les adjectifs?		
3. Avez-vous proposé des phrases contenant plusieurs propositions?		
4. Avez-vous choisi la construction appropriée après chaque mot de liaison?		
5. Avez-vous utilisé des expressions d'opinion?		
6. Avez-vous pensé à utiliser des expressions de contraste pour comparer de manière directe les deux célébrités?		

Prenez l'habitude de créer votre propre checklist avant de réaliser une production écrite ou orale, et servez-vous en pour vous évaluer une fois l'activité réalisée.

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2 Learning to read press articles about famous people

Comment améliorer la compréhension écrite

Un des moyens les plus sûrs d'accélérer votre apprentissage de la langue parlée, pour pouvoir bien comprendre des documents écrits, c'est de lire de l'anglais authentique autant que possible. Nous vous proposons de nombreux exemples dans ces fascicules de cours, mais plus vous le faites de vous-même, pendant vos loisirs, plus vous progresserez vite. Par exemple, profitez de cette séquence sur le monde des célébrités pour lire un magazine "people" en version originale – ou en surfant sur le net à la recherche d'informations sur vos idoles préférés, en vous obligeant à consulter uniquement des sites en anglais. Essayez-le! Aujourd'hui, de plus en plus de candidats qui utilisent l'anglais comme outil de recherche obtiennent d'excellentes notes au baccalauréat. Ne passez pas à côté de votre chance!

Vanessa Redgrave during a demo on Trafalgar Square against the Vietnam war.

© Rue des archives / BCA.

Activity 4

1 Study the photograph and speak for as long as possible about it (say where you think it was taken, the identity of the people present, the occasion...). Try to differentiate between what you know for sure and what is pure conjecture.

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2 Look at the different means of expressing fact and conjecture in the table below:

FACT	CONJECTURE
Simple present/preterit **Adverbs expressing certainty:** Clearly Obviously Undoubtedly	**Adverbs expressing possibility:** Maybe Perhaps Probably (un) likely **Modals expressing degrees of probability:** Might (25% probable) Could (30% probable) May (50% probable) Must (100% probable)

Express fact and conjecture

3 Now complete the blanks in the following commentary of the photograph using the verbs between brackets in an appropriate way. Don't forget to use either adverbs or modals.

This black and white photograph ..... (be taken) in the 1960's because the girl in the centre is wearing a miniskirt and she has drawn a flower on her poster, which ..... (be linked) with the hippy era and "flower power". Even if we can't see the signs properly; these people .... (protest) against war and .... (demonstrate) for peace. The demonstration ..... (take place) in the United States or in Great Britain, but in any case, it ..... (occur) in an English-speaking country, or in front of the Embassy of an English-speaking country. The girl on the right .... (be) of Asian origin, so ..... the war they are protesting about concerns an Asian country. I don't know which of the people in the picture is famous: it ..... (be) either of the two girls, or indeed both.

Check your answers.

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4 In the 1960's, Vanessa Redgrave made the news as an actress who was committed to defending policital causes even if she risked being unpopular. Look at this photograph of Vanessa Redgrave.

Vanessa Redgrave,
© WARNER BROS TV / Album / AKG.

What sort of person do you think she is today? (Try to express your opinion using structures expressing facts and conjecture.) Do not write them down first.

Activity 5

Read this recent press article referring to Vanessa Redgrave. Then do the activities that follow.

Vanessa Redgrave helps Guantanamo suspects

Two suspected al-Qa'eda operatives released from Guantanamo Bay have walked free from court although they are still wanted in Spain on terrorism-related offences.

One of the men, who is accused of distributing extremist propaganda produced by Osama bin Laden, had half of his £50,000 bail surety met by the actress Vanessa Redgrave.

Jamil el-Banna, 45, who was said during a brief court hearing to have helped run a cell called the Islamic Alliance, recruiting people to fight jihad in Afghanistan and Indonesia, returned to his London home tonight.

The other man, Omar Deghayes, 38, a Libyan national freed from Guantanamo and allowed into the UK because he once lived here, is said to have had links to the same al-Qa'eda cell. He was also released on bail.

Spain issued European arrest warrants for both men within hours of their arrival in Britain last night from the Cuban detention centre. Miss Redgrave said: "It is a profound honour and I am glad to be alive to be able to do this."

She added: "Guantanamo Bay is a concentration camp. It is a disgrace that these men have been kept there all these years."

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But the City of Westminster Magistrates' Court heard of their alleged links to al-Qa'eda, which raised fresh questions over why the British government interceded on their behalf to allow their return here from Guantanamo...

Vanessa Redgrave helps Guantanamo suspects, By Philip Johnston,
© Telegraph Media Group Limited 2007.

1 Read the title and identify the principal "actors" in the news story. Read through the rest of the text and identify all the different ways these "actors" are referred to.

2 Read the text again and identify all the proper nouns. Circle the names of people, box the names of places and underline all the other proper nouns, deciding for each one what it designates (company, organisation). If possible, make connections between the different elements (people/places/organisations).

3 Look through the document again and identify all the temporal expressions (expressions relating to time). Use these elements to establish the timeline:

	Temporal expression	Person/Authority	Action
Present			
Recent past			
More distant past			

4 The document contains a certain number of words that you are probably not familiar with. At the same time, you should be able to recognise the semantic field by looking at these words from the text.

suspects	released	free	court	wanted	terrorism
offences	accused	bail	hearing	arrest	warrant

The semantic field is ☐ sports ☐ justice ☐ health ☐ education

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Match the definitions below with the correct word in the box above. (Look at how the context of the text to help you.)

release	○	○	legal or moral crime
court	○	○	provisional freedom before a court appearance in exchange for a sum of money
offence	○	○	to let somebody go
bail	○	○	written authorisation
hearing	○	○	meeting where legal judgments are made
warrant	○	○	session to hear evidence

5 What do you think? Choose the appropriate answer and try to justify it (you may quote the text for most questions).

	True	False	Justification
a. Press articles are usually objective.			
b. Here the journalist approves of the British governments' actions.			
c. Spain agrees with Great Britain about these suspects.			
d. Vanessa Redgrave's behaviour is questionable.			

Savoir utiliser un document de compréhension pour améliorer votre production

Un petit effort supplémentaire d'analyse stylistique chaque fois que vous abordez un support de compréhension vous fera progresser en même temps en expression.

Avez-vous remarqué quelle forme verbale le journaliste utilise ici pour parler de tout ce qui arrive aux deux terroristes ? En voici quelques exemples sous forme simplifiée :

- The two men are wanted in Spain. (*Ils sont recherchés en Espagne.*)
- One of them is accused of distributing propaganda. (*Il est accusé de distribuer de la propagande.*)
- Both men were freed from Guantanamo. (*On les a relâchés de Guantanamo.*)
- They are said to have links with Al-Qaeda. (*On dit qu'ils ont des liens avec Al-Qaeda.*)

Il s'agit de la voix passive (be + participe passé), car ce qui nous intéresse ici, c'est la situation ou les traitements endurés par ces personnes (l'identité de ceux qui les recherchent/accusent/libèrent importe peu). Vous remarquerez qu'au niveau de la traduction,

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bien souvent une structure impersonnelle avec “on” s’utilise plus facilement en français que la voix passive.

Comment diriez-vous ces phrases suivantes en anglais ?

1. Les deux hommes étaient soupçonnés d’appartenir à Al-Qaeda.
2. Ils ont été libérés de Guantanamo récemment. (*to release*)
3. La Grande Bretagne est critiquée par l’Espagne. (*to criticise*)

Check your answers.

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3 Understanding people expressing and justifying their opinion

Activity 6

Forty years after first making the news in her protest against the Vietnam War, Vanessa Redgrave found herself once more in the middle of a controversy as a result of her financial and moral support of the Guantanamo prisoners. A wide variety of people phoned in to the BBC radio to express their opinion.

FACT FILE

Since the 1960s Redgrave has supported a range of human rights causes, including opposition to the Vietnam War, nuclear disarmament, freedom for Soviet Jews, and aid for Bosnian Muslims.

1 Listen to the recordings as many times as necessary to complete the following table.

	Approval	Disapproval	Speaker's remarks
1			About V. Redgrave: About the Guantanamo prisoners:
2			About V. Redgrave: About the Guantanamo prisoners:
3			About V. Redgrave: About the Guantanamo prisoners:
4			About V. Redgrave: About the Guantanamo prisoners:

If you have difficulty understanding the recordings, do the following exercises. If you feel confident (and competent), go straight to Activity 7.

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❷ **Listen again to each part of the recording and follow the instructions.**

Part 1

Listen carefully to Part 1 and mark the text with a slash (/) at each pause. (*Marquez le texte d'un slash, chaque fois que l'interlocuteur marque une pause.*)

Words cannot describe this act of stupidity I cannot understand why Vanessa Redgrave would do this it is an awful lot of money for two people who are far from innocent it is truly appalling.

Ces pauses indiquent aux auditeurs le découpage de la chaîne parlée en unités de sens. Vous avez peut-être remarqué, en plus, que l'intonation descend en fin d'unité de sens (surtout quand il s'agit de phrases affirmatives) ; cela constitue une aide supplémentaire pour identifier la fin de l'unité de sens.

Part 2

Listen carefully to Part 2 and complete the text with the missing words or expressions (don't worry about spelling!).

If my ..... serves me, I think I saw ..... whining about the ..... of the Palestine Liberation Organisation at the ..... about ..... or so ago. At least she's ..... . She is ..... and ..... . It's a ..... there are not ..... like her.

Les mots que vous avez retrouvés sont les mots-clés du document. Vous avez dû remarquer qu'ils sont assez faciles à repérer, car ils ressortent lus de la chaîne parlée que les autres mots : on dit qu'ils sont "accentués".

Part 3

Before you listen to Part 3, look at the skeleton text below and try to understand what the speaker wants to say just by concentrating on these key words.

....., Vanessa Redgrave .... guilt-ridden rich girl ..... leftist

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ideology. ..... a wealthy acting family, ...
..... illusion ..... change the world .....
..... idealism. Why ..... stars ..... disconnected .....
reality?

Now listen carefully to Part 3 and try to complete the text with the missing words or expressions.

Repérer les mots non-accentués comme vous venez de faire est beaucoup plus difficile que repérer les mots accentués. En fait, même un anglophone n'y arrive pas, mais il n'en a pas un trop grand besoin, car vous avez dû voir que l'identification des mots-clés (accentués) nous permet de comprendre le plus gros de ce qui se dit. Les mots non accentués, qui sont surtout des mots grammaticaux, ne font que confirmer notre compréhension.

3 Listen to the recording of Part 4 three times. Note down the words and expressions you are able to pick out for each time. (Notez les nouveaux mots et expressions que vous repérez à chaque écoute).

First listening	Second listening	Third listening

Vous devriez remarquer que quand on met en application les techniques que l'on vient de voir, il est assez aisé d'augmenter sa compréhension à chaque nouvelle écoute.

Check your answers.

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Activity 7

Now let's make sure you can recognise the subjective elements (when the speaker speaks in his own name: "I/me/myself" and the expressions of opinion in the four recordings you have just studied.

1 For this activity, you have to pick out the subjective elements and the expressions of opinion in each recording and note them in the table below.

Choose the approach which suits your needs and abilities:

a. you find it relatively easy to understand the recordings when you listen to them → work directly with the CD.

b. you are not very confident with the listening activity, you prefer reading → work with the scripts (see the corrections for Activity 6)

	Subjective elements	Expressions of opinion
Part 1		
Part 2		
Part 3		
Part 4		

2 Now let's check if you can remember how to use other expressions of opinion.

Complete with the appropriate preposition (from/in/to).

1. ..... my mind
2. ..... my opinion
3. ..... my point of view
4. according ..... the journalists

3 Are you familiar with these expressions? For each one, decide if it expresses a certitude (you are sure of what you are saying) or a (fairly strong) possibility.

	Certitude	Possibility
My view is that...		
My impression is that...		
I am of the opinion that...		
It seems to me that...		
I'm under the impression that...		

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	Certitude	Possibility
I'm sure...		
I'd (would) say that...		
I guess...		

Check your answers.

4 Now write a few lines expressing your opinion on Vanessa Redgrave's intervention on behalf of the Guantanamo prisoners:

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

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4 Developing your ideas on fame and your reading skills

Activity 8

FACT FILE
To start this activity, listen to the recording to pick out significant details about Marlon Brando, the star we focus on in this part.

CD 1
Enr.6

1 Listen and find information.

Name	
Nickname	
Born - Died	
Childhood	
Reason for fame	
Most famous films	
Second career	
Political activism	
Famous quotation	

It doesn't matter if you don't find all the information, what is important is that you get a general view of why Marlon Brando is considered famous.

2 Now read the following extract from Marlon Brando's biography, then do the activities that follow:

Fame

The power and influence of a movie star is curious: I didn't ask for it or take it; people gave it to me. Simply because you're a movie star, peo-

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ple empower you with special rights and privileges. Fame and its effects on people are a fairly new phenomenon; until a couple of centuries ago, unless they were royalty or a religious prophet whose image was polished by their court or disciples who produced Scripture and Holy Writ, people were seldom famous beyond their own villages. Most people couldn't read, and what knowledge they had was passed on via word of mouth. Then along came better schools, newspapers, magazines, the dime novel[1], radio, movies and television, and fame became an instant global commodity. It took 1,500 years for Buddhism to travel up the Silk Road and establish itself in China; it took only two weeks for the Twist to go from the Peppermint Lounge to Tahiti. A century and a half ago, many Americans didn't know who they had elected president until weeks after an election because it took that long for news to reach the hinterlands[2]. Now when something happens in Bombay, people from Green Bay to Greenland know it instantly; a face is recognized around the world and people who have never accomplished anything become professional celebrities.

1. dime novel: *roman de gare.*

2. hinterlands: *arrière-pays.*

A lot of people who don't have it lust after fame and find it impossible to imagine that someone else wouldn't be interested in being famous; they can't envisage anyone turning his back on fame and all its appurtenances. But fame has been the bane of my life, and I would have gladly given it up. Once I was famous, I was never able to be Bud Brando of Libertyville, Illinois, again. One of my consistent objections to my way of making a living has been that I have been forced to live a false life, and all the people I know, with the exception of a handful, have been affected by my fame. To one degree or another everybody is affected by it, consciously or unconsciously. People don't relate to you as the person you are, but to a myth they believe you are, and the myth is always wrong. You are scorned or loved for mythic reasons that, once given a life, like zombies that stalk you from the grave – or newspaper-morgue files – live forever.

From *Songs My Mother Taught Me,* by Marlon Brando and Robert Lindsey, © 1994 by Marlon Brando. Used by permission of Random House, Inc.

Culture check

If you have difficulty identifying what certain proper nouns refer to, here are some clues. Match each one to the appropriate proper noun. (If you have had no difficulties, don't waste your time here.)

PROPER NOUN	CLUE
The Twist	Biblical writings
Buddhism	One of the world's oldest and most historically important trade routes connecting East, South and Western Asia
Holy Writ	An Oriental religion
The Silk Road	The Bible
Scripture	A 1960's dance inspired by rock & roll
The Peppermint Lounge	A city in Wisconsin situated on Lake Michigan
The Green Bay	A popular discotheque in Manhattan in the 1960's

a. The title of this extract is "fame" : **read through the text** a first time and **highlight** (*surligner*) all the words (adjectives, nouns, verbs) and expressions that you think are connected to the idea of "fame".

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b. Read the text again and identify all the proper nouns. Circle the names of people, box the names of places and underline all the other proper nouns, deciding for each one what it designates (company, organisation or something else). If possible, make connections between the different elements (people/places/organisations).

3 Read the text again paying attention to temporal expressions. Find information to complete the following table about fame and famous people.

	PAST	PRESENT
People in general		
A specific person (= Marlon Brando, author of the text)		

Check your answers.

Vocabulary help

Some of the words and expressions you have noted down may not be familiar. Here's a little exercise to help you make sense of them – match each expression with its synonym:

Expression from text	Synonym
unless	give… authority
seldom	if… not
beyond	source of problems
empower	desire something intensely
lust	rarely
bane	outside

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Activity 9

La méthodologie de la compréhension écrite

Repérer les éléments essentiels dans un support écrit n'est que la première étape de la compréhension. Ensuite il faut identifier les liens entre les différents éléments et s'en servir pour synthétiser les informations. De ce fait, il vient un moment où l'expression de vos idées est tout aussi importante que votre compréhension du document, car si vous avez compris mais ne savez pas l'exprimer, votre interlocuteur pensera que vous n'avez pas compris! C'est la raison pour laquelle nous allons nous intéresser ici à la formulation des idées avant d'approfondir la compréhension.

1 Make sure you have understood the principal ideas of the article by selecting the correct answer for each statement below:

	TRUE	FALSE
1. Most people were well-known in the past.		
2. Celebrity became more common as a result of better means of communication.		
3. There is no difference between a famous person and an unknown person.		
4. It's possible today to become famous without doing something remarkable.		
5. Famous people are not appreciated for what they really are.		
6. Marlon Brando enjoys being famous.		

2 To justify most of the statements in Exercise 1, you will need to use expressions of cause or consequence.

a. For each of the expressions below, decide whether it expresses cause or consequence and which structure follows it (just a complement (noun) or a complete proposition (subject + verb + complement)).

	CAUSE	CONSEQUENCE	+ COMPLEMENT	+ SUBJECT + VERB + COMPLEMENT
To cause				
To bring about				
Because				

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	CAUSE	CONSEQUENCE	+ COMPLEMENT	+ SUBJECT + VERB + COMPLEMENT
To lead to				
Because of				
As a consequence				
As a result of				
As a result				
That's why				
To provoke				
As				

b. Now suggest an alternative for the underlined expression in each sentence below.

1. In the past few people were famous <u>because</u> news travelled very slowly.
2. Celebrity became more common <u>as a result of</u> better means of communication.
3. Today, being famous <u>leads to</u> special privileges.
4. For Marlon Brando, being famous <u>caused</u> a lot of unhappiness.
5. <u>As a result</u>, he wishes he had never hit the limelight.

Check your answers.

Activity 10

Comment approfondir la compréhension écrite

Pour l'instant, on s'est focalisé sur la reconstruction du sens du document à partir de simples repérages et de mise en réseau, sans s'intéresser de très près à la construction des énoncés pour nous aider dans le déchiffrage du sens.

Pour aller plus loin dans la compréhension, il faut regarder les énoncés de plus près.

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❶ Look at how the pronoun "it" is used in the following sentence from the text.

A lot of people who don't have **it**[1] lust after fame and find **it**[2] impossible to imagine that someone else wouldn't be interested in being famous.

1. it = fame: A lot of people who don't have fame lust after fame (it). Le pronom remplace un nom dans le contexte immédiat.
2. it: cette fois-ci, le pronom ne remplace pas un nom spécifique, mais un segment d'énoncé (impossible to imagine that…).

❷ Study the context carefully and decide what "it" refers to in the following sentences taken from the text.

	Noun	Segment	"it"=
The power and influence of a movie star is curious: I didn't ask for **it** or take **it**;		x	The power and influence of a movie star
Now when something happens in Bombay, people from Green Bay to Greenland know **it** instantly;			
But fame has been the bane of my life, and I would have gladly given **it** up.			
… all the people I know, with the exception of a handful, have been affected by my fame. To one degree or another everybody is affected by **it**,…			

Vocabulary tip

"it"et les locutions impersonnelles

Il arrive aussi que "it" ne remplace pas un nom ou un segment d'énoncé, mais qu'il fait partie intégrante d'une locution dite impersonnelle. Nous en avons un exemple récurrent dans ce texte :

***It** took 1,500 years for Buddhism to travel up the Silk Road… it took only two weeks for the Twist to go from the Peppermint Lounge to Tahiti.*

It takes + expression de durée se traduit par : *il faut x temps*.

Check your answers.

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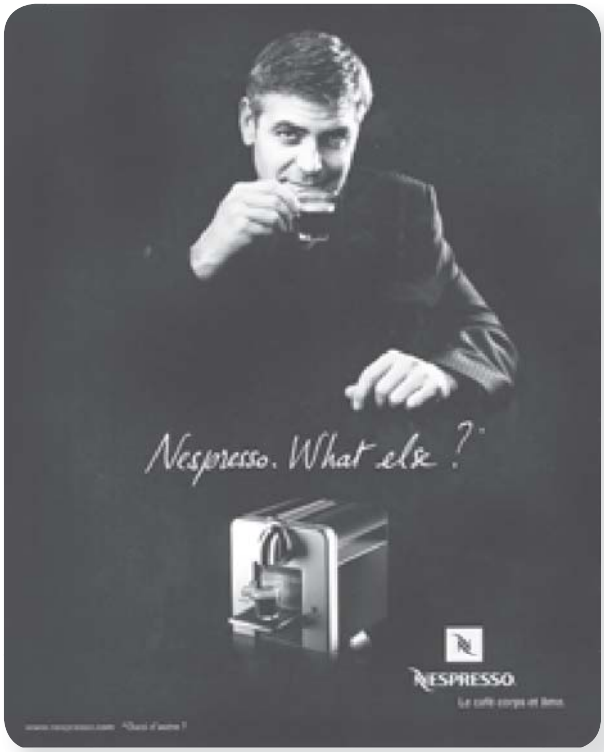
5 Making logical connections and drawing up a synthesis

Activity 11

Study these documents carefully then do the activities that follow.

Document 1



Nespresso ad with Clooney, © Rue des Archives / RDA.

Document 2

Will Bono, Clooney and Other Celebs Face Charity Controversy?

The legitimacy of a charity seems to be on everyone's mind these days. I've been amazed at the responses to the recent post on a Scientology benefit for charity. That conversation may not have been that surprising (I'm not Scientology's OMG #1 Fan myself!), but when I heard that charities run by **Bono** – one of my favorite celebs ever – **George Clooney**, and other famous people might not be as legit as they claim, I was pretty shocked.

Apparently, Bono's DATA Foundation (now part of One), which works to eliminate poverty and AIDS in Africa, raised $31 million in 2006 – but

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only used $6 million of that for charity. The rest went to transportation, security, and U2 tour tickets. Clooney's Not on Our Watch (also founded by **Brad Pitt, Matt Damon, Don Cheadle** and others), which fights genocide, has some shady dealings[1] with an offshore gambling company[2]. **Wyclef Jean, Osi Umenyiora, Tyra Banks, Larry King, Gary Payton, Petra Nemcova, Magic Johnson** and **Dyan Cannon** also seem to have skeletons in their charities' closets; read more about them here.

So what do you think? Do a few gray areas make a charity all bad? Do any of these charities sound completely illegitimate to you, or do you think they still have redeeming qualities?

D.R.

1. shady dealings: suspicious transactions.

2. gambling company: *entreprise qui se spécialise dans les jeux d'argent.*

Document 3 George Clooney's charity saves WFP ops in Darfur

Can celebrities save the world? They might be only fictional heroes of large Hollywood productions, but their image and money have great power when it comes to support humanitarian causes and serve as a tool to make this world a better place.

© Photo Jemal Countess / WireImage / Getty Images.

Not On Our Watch (NOOW), the advocacy organization founded by the actors George Clooney, Don Cheadle, Matt Damon, and Brad Pitt, has donated $500,000 to the Humanitarian Air Service run by the United Nations World Food Programme (WFP) in Darfur. It is the first donation received after an appeal by the Rome-based UN agency to save the operations of this vital helicopters and airplanes service from being ended. Earlier this week, the Humanitarian Air Service, whose 24-aircraft fleet carry crucial supplies and relief workers to remote parts of Darfur, announced that by the end of March it would be forced to cease operations because no confirmed donations had arrived to its $77 million budget this year.

It is the second NOOW donation to the humanitarian service run by WFP, after the organization granted $1 million in 2007.

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“Having seen first hand the epic humanitarian challenge in Darfur, George Clooney and his colleagues know the life-saving power of the Humanitarian Air Service,” said Josette Sheeran, WFP’s Executive Director. “This contribution will make a difference to the millions of vulnerable women and children trapped there, and we hope it will inspire other donations.”

George Clooney, recently named Messenger of Peace by the United Nations, has been the biggest fundraiser in Hollywood for helping Darfur and Sudan.

“World Food Programme planes and helicopters deliver humanitarian workers and urgent supplies to nearly every aid organization working in Darfur,” said Clooney in a statement. “This is a critical time for the programme. Without immediate additional funding, humanitarian aid in the region will be crippled. We are proud to help ensure the survival of this life-saving programme and strongly encourage others to do the same. Protection of these victims should not fall solely in the hands of charitable organizations. Governments have a responsibility to help those who cannot defend themselves.”

An average of 8,000 relief workers in Darfur, who provide essential food assistance, water and healthcare services, use WFP’s Humanitarian Air Service each month. This number includes 3,000 passengers on the six helicopters traveling to the most remote parts of Darfur, unreachable due to insecurity and lack of road access.

NOOW’s donation follows another large personal contribution to the UN agency by actress Drew Barrymore, who announced a donation of $1 million live on The Oprah Winfrey Show’ earlier this month.

The money will be used to help the WFP feed thousands of school children in Kenya and kicks off WFP’s challenge to America to help feed 10 million children for a year.

“I have seen with my own eyes what a difference a simple cup of nutritious porridge can make in a child’s life,” said Drew Barrymore. “It helps them learn, stay healthy and sets them on track for a bright future. I urge everyone—everywhere—to help WFP “Fill the Cup” for hungry children, and make hunger history.”

Published March 14, 2008 By the Gstaad Project,
by Andreas Sandre von Warburg.

(www.gstaadproject.com)

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❶ **Identify the common factor(s) in all three documents.**

❷ **Pick out the relevant details in each document to complete this table in relation with the common factor you have just identified.**

	POSITIVE ELEMENTS	NEGATIVE ELEMENTS
Document 1		Clooney makes money out of his image by doing publicity for (endorsing/supporting) Nestlé products.
Document 2		
Document 3		

Check your answers.

Activity 12

❶ **Imagine you have been asked to express your opinion on "how celebrities use their fame".**

Use the elements in the documents and the answers to Activity 11 to organise your ideas according to the following plan.

		YOUR IDEAS
Introduction	Explanation of subject	
Part one	Positive approach	
Part two	Negative approach	
Conclusion	Your personal opinion	

❷ **Now use your notes in the table above to record your oral presentation on the subject.**

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CD 1 Enr.7

❸ **When you are satisfied with the quality of your presentation, listen to the model answer and assess your own work**

S'auto-évaluer en production orale

Au début de la séquence, nous vous avons guidé pour votre première auto-évaluation de la production écrite.

Essayons maintenant de faire la même chose pour la production orale :

	oui	non
1. Avez-vous parlé sans lire des notes rédigées?		
2. Le ton est-il dynamique et convaincant?		
3. Vos propos sont-ils facilement compréhensibles?		
4. Votre discours est-il cohérent et structuré?		
5. Avez-vous utilisé des mots de liaisons pour articuler votre discours?		
6. Avez-vous pensé à utiliser des expressions d'opinion?		
7. Avez-vous utilisé un vocabulaire riche et varié?		
8. Maîtrisez-vous les structures que vous avez utilisées?		
9. Votre prononciation respecte-elle les règles de l'anglais parlé (phonèmes, rythme et intonation)?		

Prenez l'habitude de créer votre propre checklist avant de réaliser une production écrite ou orale, et servez-vous en pour vous évaluer une fois l'activité réalisée.

Activity 13

Study a model answer.

The purpose of this activity is to study the model answer for the oral presentation to help you progress. We invite you to choose how to do this activity depending on how comfortable you feel with the model answer.

CD 1 Enr.7

▸ You found the model answer relatively easy to understand: listen to it again to do the following exercises.

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▶ You found the model answer rather difficult to understand: look at the script in the answer pages to do the following exercises.

❶ Listen to or look at the model answer and pick out the words and expressions used in order to complete Column 2.

	MODEL ANSWER	POSSIBLE ANSWERS
To indicate the order of the different parts (in the introduction)	*First of all*	
To introduce a reformulation		
As a synonym for 'in a positive way'		
As a synonym for 'in a negative way'		
To introduce the most important argument		
As a synonym for 'however'		
To introduce the final argument		
To introduce a counter argument		
To introduce another argument		
To announce the conclusion		
To express an unfavourable opinion		
To express a favourable opinion		

❷ Now complete the third column of the table with other expressions that you know.

Check your answers.

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6 On the way to autonomy

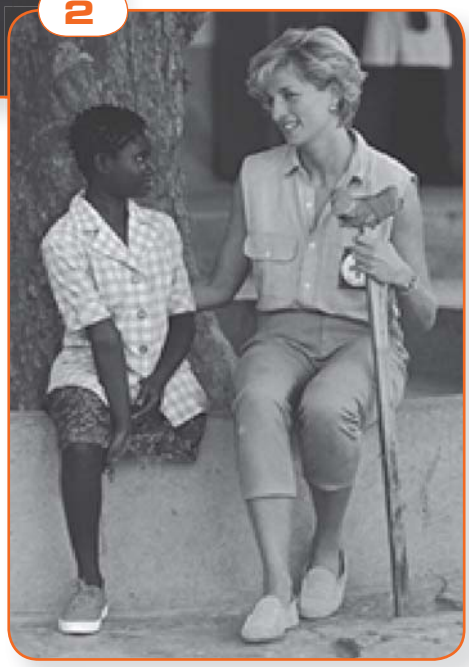
Dossier (2 photographs, 1 biography & a recorded document)

A Photographs

1

Wedding of Prince Charles and Lady Diana, July 29, 1981. © Rue des Archives / AGIP2.

2



The Princess Diana and goodwill ambassador for the International Committee of the Red Cross. © Photo Antonio Cotrim / LUSA / AFP.

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B Biography outline

NAME	Diana, Princess of Wales
DATES	1 July 1961 – 31 August 1997
FAMILY BACKGROUND	1st wife of Charles, Prince of Wales Mother of Prince William & Prince Harry
ACHIEVEMENTS	Worked as a kindergarten assistant Married Prince Charles at the age of 20
REASONS FOR MAKING THE NEWS	Did not always do as the Royal Family wished Supported numerous charities especially AIDS & the International Campaign to Ban Landmines[1] The 1st public figure to be photographed touching someone infected with HIV Divorced Charles after 15 years of unhappy marriage Died in a car crash in Paris with her lover Dodi Al Fayed: conspiracy theory

1. *Campagne Internationale contre les Mines Terrestres.*

C Recorded document

Activity 14

CD 1

Listen to the audio document.

Imagine you are listening to a radio debate on this subject: "fame and happiness are incompatible".

Decide what your views on the subject are, then record your message on the programme's voice box. Try to talk for 1 minute 30 seconds using ideas from this dossier on Princess Diana and the rest of the sequence. (Don't forget to do an auto-assessment of your message.)

CD 1

Check your answers.

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